

CLEARTAX KEYNOTE

Finance in the **Age of AI**

Transformation for the CFO's office during and post the e-invoicing world



Archit Gupta

Founder & CEO, Cleartax

Today, we will talk about

01

e-Invoicing

Where mandates across the Middle East and the world are headed, and what it takes to get ready.

02

AI for the CFO's office

How structured, compliant data becomes the foundation for AI-driven finance transformation.

SINCE 2011

cleartax

Serving governments & businesses since 2011

750+

Engineers & compliance experts

40+

Global enterprises

500M+

Invoices processed

5000+

e-Invoices generated annually

Local UAE entity with local support

Countries covered globally

\$500B+

The global tax technology trusted by finance teams worldwide.

Cleartax solves everything in & around e-invoicing



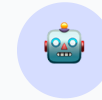
VAT compliance

- Deep reconciliations across Forex, time-of-supply, date sources (GL, SR, PR)
- Built into e-invoicing, and available standalone as Cleartax Compliance Cloud



Global e-invoicing

- Master data management, self-billing, DIY error-correction workflows
- Partner network for due diligence & gap analysis to fit taxpayer needs



AI agents for CFOs

- Deep innovation in fraud detection and many-to-many reconciliations
- Advanced technologies powering taxpayer support at scale



AP transformation

- AP inbox, 3-way reconciliation on inbound e-invoices
- Adjacent offerings within Cleartax Supply Chain Cloud

**Powering Fortune 500s worldwide, and growing
by 2 new logos every day**

Pioneering ZATCA-compliant e-invoicing in the GCC

400+

Customers live for e-invoicing

500+

Enterprise customers in GCC

3,000+

Large enterprise customers for e-invoicing

5000+

Individual users on the Cleartax e-inv solution

Locally hosted cloud servers

PEPPOL-ready, easy integration with ERPs

\$500B+

Worth of e-invoices generated across the region.

Powering the world's e-invoicing rails alongside regulators



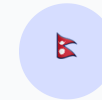
Malaysia

Aligned with LHDN's guidelines and MDEC accredited.



India

Advisory role during the Phase-1 e-invoicing pilot; one of the first service providers approved for Phase-II.



India (GSTN)

Licensed to generate e-invoices for taxpayers on behalf of the Indian tax authority.

UAE

Aligned with the FTA and in the process of Service Provider Accreditation.

CUSTOMER TRUST

Trusted by **500+ large enterprises** across the GCC



Customer logo wall – placeholder (source deck logos not available in this content extract)

**Trusted by multiple Sovereign-sponsored
taxpayers in the Gulf**

From the Middle East to the EU, tax mandates are moving to real-time — where every e-invoice triggers compliance automatically.

And that future is taking shape across the world...

90+

**countries have adopted or
announced e-invoicing mandates**

75%

**of global B2B transactions will be
electronic by 2030**

What the world has taught us about e-invoicing

KSA – B2C

Leading real-time B2C e-invoicing, transforming compliance for retail & e-commerce at point of sale.

India – Scale

12B+ invoices processed annually across a \$2.4T economy; 1 in 10 invoices flows via Cleartax.

Brazil – Recovery

Recovered over \$58B in tax revenues since e-invoicing rollout.

Mexico – Financing

90% of SMEs use CFDI data to access credit lines & supply chain financing.

Europe – Interop.

EU's €134B VAT gap – e-invoicing expected to close a significant portion by 2030.

MENA is at the same turning point that India, Brazil, and Europe once faced. The decisions CFOs make today will define tomorrow's finance.

Country key milestones

(indicative timelines*)

Country	Key milestones
Saudi Arabia	Dec 2020 regulations introduced · Dec 2021 Phase 1 (generation & record-keeping) required · 1 Jan 2023 Phase 2 begins (integration/transmission to ZATCA) · 2023–2025 Phase 2 rolled out in waves by revenue threshold – recent: Wave 18 (turnover > SAR 2m) by 1 Jun 2025, Wave 21 (turnover > SAR 1.25m) by 30 Nov 2025.
UAE	Oct/Nov 2024 laws & portal launched (Decree-Law amendments) · 2025 preparation – service provider accreditation & technical specifications · Jul 2026 Phase 1 go-live anticipated for initial taxpayer groups · Beyond 2026, phased inclusion expands to smaller taxpayers / B2C.
Oman	Aug 2025 Tax Authority piloting with the first ~100 large taxpayers · Sep 2026 first mandatory wave for large taxpayers, B2B model based on Peppol · 2027–2028 subsequent waves expand to more B2B and B2G taxpayers.
Other	Bahrain – planning stage, likely following Oman/UAE (no confirmed dates yet). Qatar – consultation in progress; timeline likely aligned with VAT implementation phases.



E-invoicing for B2B & B2G transactions will be mandatory in the UAE starting July 2026. UAE will adopt the DCTCE or 5-corner model, utilizing PEPPOL specifications.

– Ministry of Finance, UAE

10 years of revolution (VAT) and evolution (e-invoicing) in the UAE



From manual paperwork to continuous transaction control

STAGE 1

Unstructured format

Manual processes · human readable · PDF, Word, Excel
· periodic reporting

STAGE 2

Hybrid format

Human & machine readable · PDF/A-3 with XML · real-time reporting

STAGE 3

Structured format

Machine readable · XML (CII/UBL) / JSON · continuous transaction control · fully automated invoice processing

It's the starting point for real-time tax compliance



IT × Finance

Sits squarely at the intersection of IT and Finance teams.



Multiple stakeholders

Internal user teams, customers, vendors, and governments all involved.



Fragmented IT systems

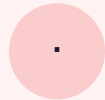
Different ERP, POS, and order management systems in play.



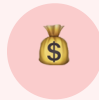
Data complexity

Different formats, quality, correctness, integrity, and reconciliation needs – against mandates like PEPPOL (4/5-corner) and CTC.

Four risks that derail most e-invoicing rollouts



Underestimating time



Unpredictable cost



Lack of resources



Data complexity

Additional / unpredictable cost and lack of resources compound quickly once data complexity is underestimated.

Implementing new mandates may initially appear as issues of manpower, timelines, and security.

But there are deeper issues — expertise in IT / tax / compliance, reconciliation, and hidden costs.

Problems for CFOs to solve (and collaborate with the CIO on)

Disparate ERP systems

Multiple accounting/billing systems — not all built with superior tech architecture.

Evolving tax laws

Digital-first governments continuously launch new laws and amendments.

Vendor as key stakeholder

Smaller vendors may not be compliant, creating chain-wide risk.

Legacy ERPs

ERPs not updating fast enough for the new world of digital tax infrastructure.

Reporting 2.0

Reporting expectations are being rewritten in real time.

How should you select technology solutions?

1

Compliant, secure & private

- Local hosting in GCC for data residency
- ISO27001, SOC-2, GDPR, FTA, SAMA, VAPT, RMIT compliant

2

Single unified platform

- UAE, MENA, Asia and EU under one roof
- Arabic & local language support; VAT/GST automation & reconciliation

3

Future compliance roadmap

- Coverage for what's next, not just what's mandated today
- AP automation, AR automation on the roadmap

4

Ecosystem expertise

- Plugins for all major ERP, POS and OMS systems
- Connected with Big 4s and local advisory firms

How will e-invoicing help you?



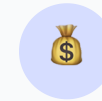
More efficiency

Saves time, reduces error, streamlines processes.



Enhanced compliance

Automatically generated audit trails support legal compliance.



Faster payments

Instant invoice delivery speeds up approvals and cash flow.



Better relationships

Smoother transactions improve customer support.



Enhanced security

Secure transmission and encryption throughout.



Expanded global reach

Instant cross-border invoicing for international business.

e-invoicing isn't the finish line — use it for re-invention

With all finance transactions now digital and certified, you can re-invent:



Tax transformation

via technology



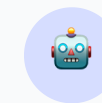
Supply chain

automation



Risk detection

& prevention



AI in finance

across the office

WHAT WILL E-INVOICING CHANGE?

Everything.

More business impact — reinforcing the importance of AI

Accounts Payable

**Accounts
Receivable**

Tax Compliance

10x more business impact

Accounts Payable

- Automated invoice capture
- Faster approvals
- AI detection of duplicates & fraud

Accounts Receivable

- Quicker invoice clearance
- Stronger cash flow visibility
- Fewer disputes

Tax Compliance

- AI-driven accurate, real-time validation
- AI bots power reconciliation & reporting
- Connected data for predictive governance

Compliance in the UAE will evolve beyond e-invoicing

1

e-Invoicing begins, 2026

2

Stricter compliance with output VAT filing

3

Pre-population of VAT returns from e-invoices

4

Supplier accountability affects claim-ability on input tax

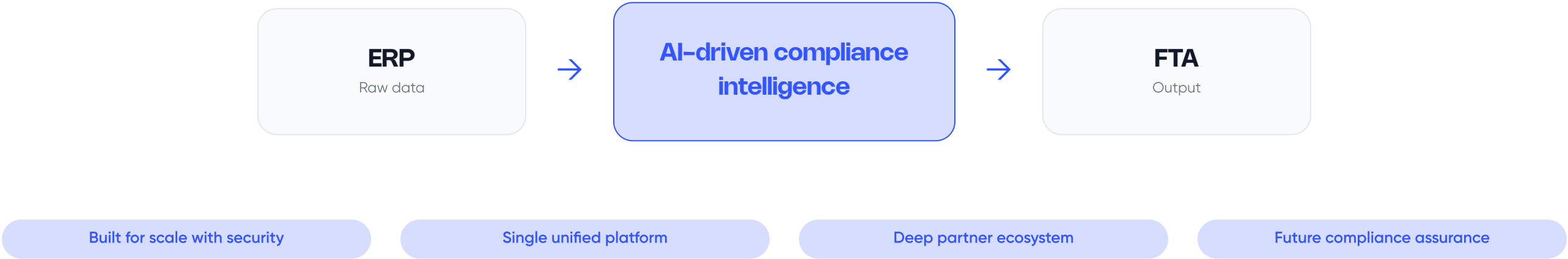
5

Increased regulatory scrutiny on return filing & compliance

What approach can businesses take?

Legacy approach	Cleartax approach	
Project-by-project approach with individual, complex custom builds	Product-based approach with pre-built workflows for each mandate	Speed to compliance
Multiple solutions per country, needing different vendors & separate integration projects	Single unified platform across geographies	Operational simplicity
Not scalable – hard to react to new mandates	Built for scale with security	Future-proofing
Dependency on service-provider professional services	Deep partner ecosystem for integrations & services	Ecosystem leverage

It's really an AI-driven data project



Covering all compliance & automation use-cases for the CFO's office across 50+ countries

SOURCES

- ERP / OMS / Billing / PoS
- Manual upload via Excel
- Custom integration (SFTP/DB)
- API integration (plug & play ERP connectors)

CONNECT & PROCESS

- ERP Connect & Global e-inv Portal
- Partner Connect
- Data transformation & validation
- CT e-invoicing Portal & CT Router
- PEPPOL & direct Govt. Connect (future)

OUTCOMES

- **Compliance:** tax filing, reconciliation, alerts, Govt. interaction
- **Supply chain:** AP/AR automation, business insight, archival, partners

**For CFOs, a global platform delivers true value
when powered by AI**

Data. Tools. That's all AI needs.



Data

- Build the most comprehensive finance data lake your team always wanted
- AI-powered GL-Stream makes this unique to you
- Seamlessly integrate ERP data with GL-Stream, extending it across your network via Peppol for end-to-end compliance intelligence



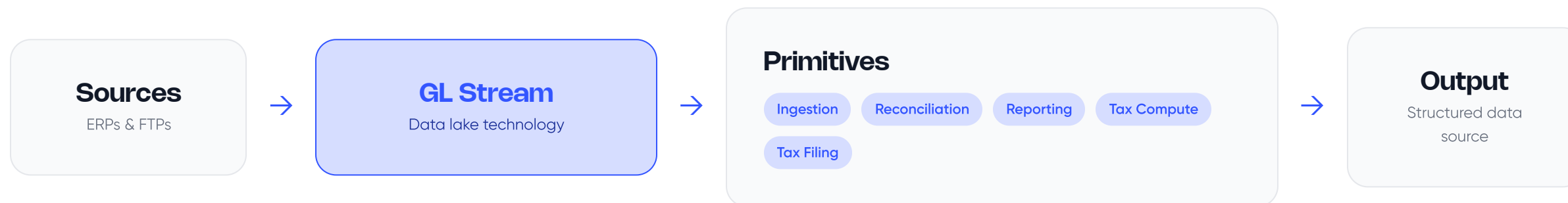
Tools

- Don't use AI for just asking questions or chat
- Use AI to reconcile, ingest, validate, and communicate
- Put AI to work

QUICK INTEGRATION, CLEAN DATA

cleartax

The AI + GL Stream stack



What will AI deliver for finance teams?



Assurance

All your reporting is accurate — so compliance/audit is not a burden.



Data lake

A single source of truth for actionable insights — no manual work, no double-checking.



Adapt to changes

AI agents communicate and coordinate for you as mandates evolve.

**It is our commitment to help CFOs design, scale,
and deliver value with AI**

The question is not *if* you adapt, but how fast you turn compliance into intelligence.

Five things to act on, starting now

- 1 Rethink compliance as strategy** – treat e-invoicing as a catalyst for finance transformation, not just a mandate.
- 2 Put data at the center** – every invoice is structured intelligence; unlock insights, not just reports.
- 3 Prepare for CTC and beyond** – the UAE is only the start; global convergence on pre-issuance models is inevitable.
- 4 Build trust through transparency** – validated, standardized data strengthens credibility with regulators and stakeholders.
- 5 Experiment with AI now** – start with pilots in reconciliation, anomaly detection, or forecasting; scale as data quality improves.

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Thank you!

Archit Gupta – Founder & CEO, Cleartax